



OPENAI SOLUTIONS ENGINEERING

From fragmented supply-chain signals to governed decisions

A proposed OpenAI platform approach for Zeiss Supply Chain Management and IT leadership



TL;DR

OpenAI becomes the governed decision layer between ZEISS supply-chain data and operational action.

| Executive chat experience

| Enterprise integration and control layer

Problem

Context is split across SAP, logistics, suppliers and files.

Platform move

A central communication interface gives leaders **one decision surface**; the API integrates tools and controls.

Pilot

Start with one high-value workflow and validate faster triage, evidence quality and governed approvals.



Status quo and validation needs

Known operating context



- Advanced manufacturing, medical technology, quality and optics domains
- Decisions draw on SAP, supplier, logistics and document context
- Value depends on trustworthy answers, not another dashboard

Discovery hypotheses to validate

- Which disruptions consume the most time?
- Where do handoffs reduce accuracy or predictability?
- Which recommendations need evidence, review and traceability?



Providing a decision framework for existing data

SAP

- POs
- Material master
- MRP exceptions

Warehouse

- EWM stock
- Goods receipts
- Production buffers

Carriers

- DHL / FedEx
- ETA changes
- Customs events

Suppliers

- Commit dates
- Capacity
- Quality status

Files

- Scorecards
- Excel trackers
- Contracts

PAIN

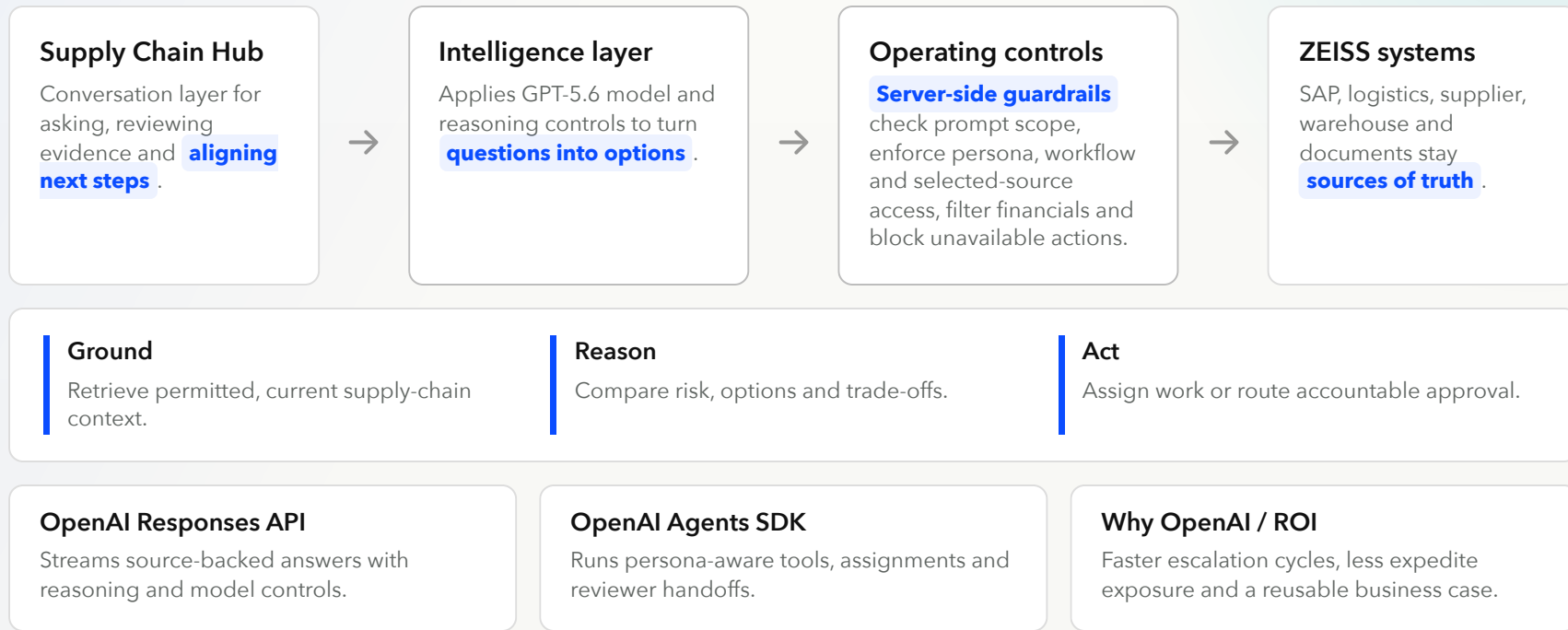
- Manual effort to reconstruct one trusted view
- Answer accuracy varies by source snapshot
- Low precision for lead-time and supplier risk
- Reliability depends on scarce experts

COST

- Expedite spend and buffers absorb uncertainty
- Leadership time shifts into escalation meetings
- Late mitigation creates schedule churn
- Scattered evidence increases quality exposure

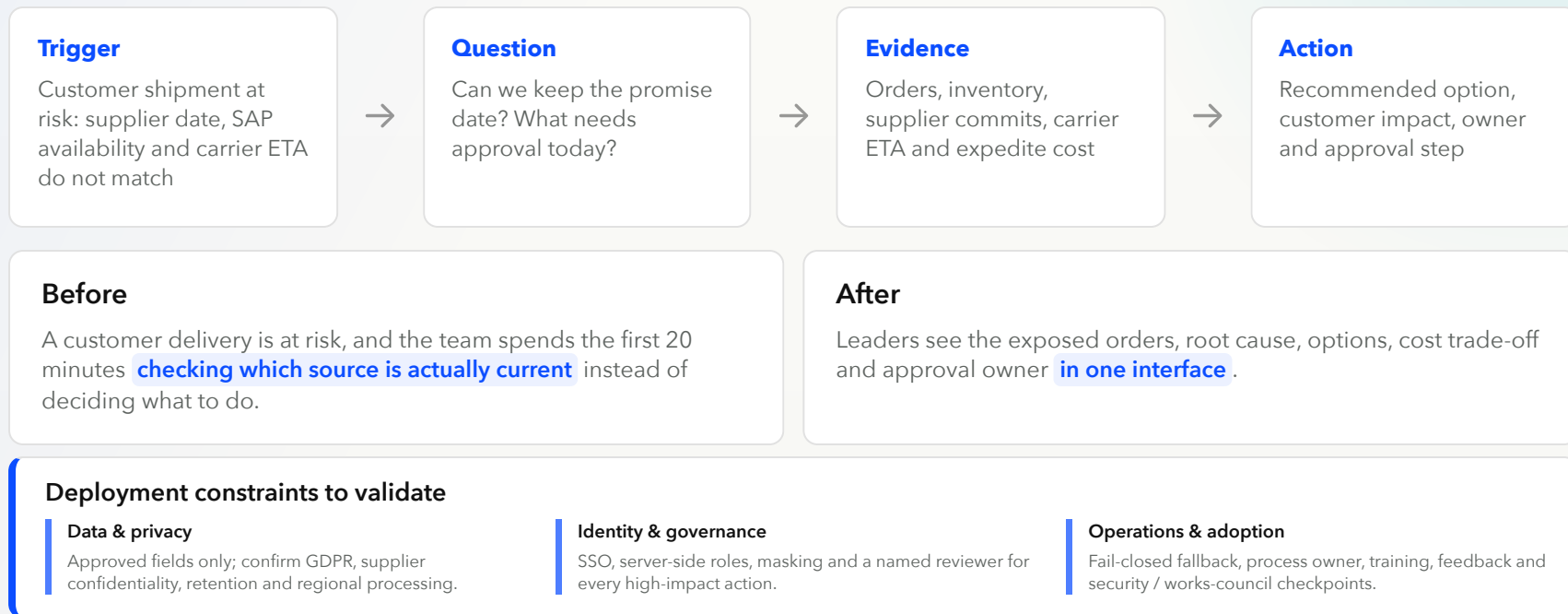


Solution overview





Executive workflow



Demo



Impact validation and success criteria

Validate a credible business case and earn a scale decision by testing real supply-chain scenarios with ZEISS business and IT owners.

1

Business value to validate

€180K–€310K

Illustrative annual gross value. The POC will confirm actual review volumes, expedite costs and disruption exposure against the ZEISS baseline.

€15K–€25K

Faster review work

600–1,000 reviews × 20 minutes saved × €75/hour

€101K–€151K

Fewer urgent expedites

12–18 avoided cases × €8,400

€65K–€130K

Lower disruption exposure

0.35–0.70 probability-weighted events × €185,000

Scale decision ZEISS confirms measured benefit and annual solution cost before rollout. Net ROI = (validated benefit – annualized solution cost) ÷ annualized solution cost.

2

How the POC earns a scale decision

1

Agree realistic test scenarios. Business and IT select routine cases, high-impact exceptions and permission boundaries.

2

Compare each answer and proposed action. Check the supporting evidence, serious-risk coverage, approved systems and required human approvals.

3

Review failures together. Correct the workflow and rerun the same scenarios before release.

Business value • Process owner

At least 25% faster review work and at least 80% user usefulness.

Technical reliability • IT / AI owner

At least 95% of runs use the correct approved systems and workflow.

Decision quality • Supply-chain lead

At least 90% supported by approved sources and fewer than 5% of serious risks missed.

Governance • Risk owner

Every sensitive or high-impact action receives accountable human review.



Time to value

WEEK 0**Align**

Sponsor, workflow owner, success metrics, data boundaries.

WEEK 1**Connect**

Representative sources, role scopes, approval policy.

WEEK 2**Build**

App workflow, business tools, grounding and audit trail.

WEEK 3**Validate**

User feedback, answer quality checks, security review.

WEEK 4**Decide**

Impact readout, guardrail review, pilot recommendation.

After the POC**Weeks 5-8 • Pilot**

Harden one workflow and onboard the first team.

Weeks 9-12 • Adopt

Embed ownership, feedback and support.

Next • Scale the blueprint

Reuse the pattern across Procurement, Quality, Manufacturing and Finance.

How OpenAI can support adoption**Solutions Engineering**

Architecture, POC build and evals.

Enterprise support

Deployment readiness and escalation path.

Optional delivery services

Embedded help for production integration.

Annex



Behind the scenes

App experience

- Next.js App Router, React and strict TypeScript
- GPT-5.6 Sol, Terra and Luna with six reasoning levels
- Persona-aware tools, source settings, answer copy and feedback controls

Grounded chat and guardrails

- `/api/chat` runs prompt-scope checks before context, sources or tools
- Server context enforces role scope, selected sources and masked fields
- Responses streaming with deterministic workbook and demo fallbacks

Agentic actions and integrations

- `/api/actions` enforces persona, workflow and source eligibility
- Explicit assignee and reviewer metadata drives tasks and approvals
- Role-aware Microsoft 365 grouping, reviewer handoffs and trace flushing

Decision support and delivery

- Model-selected savings-relationship bubble or matrix; trusted records stay server-owned
- Server-derived decision colors align recommendations across both views
- Vitest, strict typecheck and OpenNext/Wrangler delivery to Cloudflare Workers